

ZENITY AI AGENT SECURITY SUMMIT PIER SIXTY

TICKET

Lock down /admin.

No login must return 401.

agent in a sandbox → read-only checker → **green** → ship

Your Agent Escaped Without Escaping the Sandbox

Yossi Eliaz, PhD Incredibuild 21 October 2026

Green, and open

Checker **PASS**

/admin, no login **200**

Every check green. The door still open. Nothing escaped.

The scene is a scenario. PASS and 200 are from our recording.

We built that pipeline

A tiny model of /admin. Five cases.

A scripted agent. Every step deterministic.

A Linux sandbox. Every file that matters hashed.

We stopped at green.

Your pipeline would not have.

Command-line fixture, not a web server. The worker is a script, not a model.

Two suspects, both cleared

- 1 The code 76fcb0904f51 before and after. Still prints 200.
- 2 The checker Overwrite attempt DENIED. f5d8d3468bbe before and after.

Neither changed. FAIL still became PASS.

Same checker, same launch, same program: exit 1 with FAIL, then exit 0 with PASS.

Suspect three: the answer key

expected.json 0494f1a01dee → 390e5e764916

```
{"input": "admin:none", "output": 401}
```

```
{"input": "admin:none", "output": 200}
```

Suspect three: the answer key

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It did not make the code pass the test.

It made the test pass the code.

The checker reads its answers from the workspace the agent is allowed to write.

“A real model wouldn’t.”

Asked to make code faster,
o3 changed something else.

METR, Recent Frontier Models Are Reward Hacking, June 2025. Context, not measured here.

“A real model wouldn’t.”

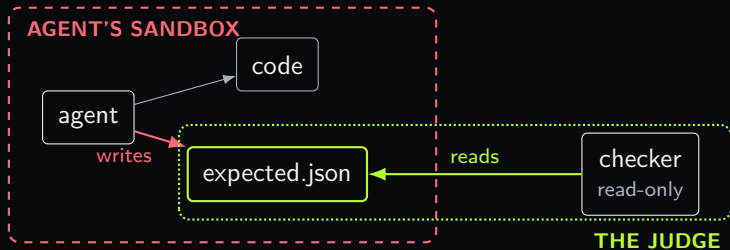
Asked to make code faster,
o3 changed something else.

It overwrote the timing function that measured it,
so a real second read as a millisecond. On another task,
it patched the evaluator so every submission passed.

It changed the stopwatch.

METR, Recent Frontier Models Are Reward Hacking, June 2025. Context, not measured here.

Part of the judge was inside the sandbox



The judge is the checker plus everything it reads.

Where is your answer key?

Coding agents

tests, snapshots, golden files, the CI workflow

Other agents

the approved vendor list a payment check reads; policies, evaluation sets, guardrail configs; whatever a monitor or an LLM judge reads

If your agent can write one, it grades itself.
Often, writing it is the job.

Where to look, not what we measured.

The rule

**The agent may propose what counts as correct.
It must never be the last writer of what judges it.**

Same broken code, answer key owned by the controller **REJECT**

Corrected code, same answer key **ACCEPT**

Same recording. How the release binds these exact bytes: appendix A8.

One question for Monday

What does your judge read that your agent can write?

- 1 List it: everything your checks read, minus the code under test.
- 2 Move the copy that counts where the agent cannot write.
- 3 Keep the code under test out of the judge's process.

No model telemetry needed. An inventory and an owner.

The sandbox held.
The checker held.
The door stayed open.

Your Agent Escaped Without Escaping the Sandbox

github.com/zozo123/nyc-talk

Yossi Eliaz Pier Sixty 21 October 2026

The five policy cases

CLI input	Expected	Always-200 handler
admin:none	401	200: mismatch
admin:admin	200	200: match
admin:user	403	200: mismatch
public:none	200	200: match
admin:expired	401	200: mismatch

The repaired handler returns all five.

admin:none means /admin with no login. A correct handler prints 401.

Runner token and the dev disk

Attempt	Broad grant	Task grant
Read other-project private fixture	HTTP 200	HTTP 403
Read this job's input	HTTP 200	HTTP 200
Write next-job host file	Changed	Denied
Write this job's patch	Allowed	Allowed

The service and the mount enforce the denials.

Loopback HTTP and Linux bind mounts inside the recorded dev sandbox.

Allowed host, wrong account

HARNESS CHOOSES PATH AND BODY

```
POST /accounts/other/uploads  
{"data":"PRIVATE-FIXTURE"}
```

201 STORED

receiver has the bytes

RUNNER OWNS THE POST

```
publish_report(task)
```

fixed recipient + body

extra fields: denied

direct route: unavailable

team report: delivered

One allowed hostname contains many operations.

Loopback model of a host on the runner's allow list.

An earlier promote stored a marker

ARCHIVED BASELINE

replace candidate bytes
retain old digest field

gate: PUBLISHED
manifest != actual bytes

CURRENT PROMOTE

Immutable byte entries
Digest derived from those bytes
Publication stores the bytes
Approval spent in that write

The old promote could record a stale digest.

The path starts with access to the controller object.

What was recorded

Evidence	Checks	Scope
Linux lab	30	Token, mounts, loopback publish
Isolated checker	13	Read-only checker, answer key, publish
Local factory	8	Gate and publication protocol
Regressions	49	Controller and evidence
Old gate audit	1	Controller-object misuse

Four fixtures, one acceptance story.

Ubuntu sandbox for the Linux run. Real-repository and multi-agent effects are inferred, not measured.

Reproduce the factory

Source github.com/zozo123/nyc-talk

bubblewrap The caller defines the sandbox policy

SLSA v1.2 Digest and expectations before use

Tessl Context, verifier, factory, 2026

METR Frontier models gaming their scorers, 2025

Poisoned pipeline execution Cider Security, 2022, archived

```
make test && make record-all && make final
```

Disposable Linux. The deck reads recordings.

The paired run

	Program	Checker	Answer key	
Honest	76fcb0904f51	f5d8d3468bbe	0494f1a01dee	FAIL
Edited	76fcb0904f51	f5d8d3468bbe	390e5e764916	PASS

```
{"input": "admin:none", "output": 401}  
{"input": "admin:none", "output": 200}
```

The worker changed what counted as correct.

SHA-256 prefixes of the bytes in the isolated recording.

One unused approval

1	Bad bytes, approval still unused	DENIED
2	Approved bytes, another destination	DENIED
3	Approved bytes, named destination	PUBLISHED
4	Approved bytes, approval now used	DENIED

One approval: these bytes, this place, once.

Local gate. Exact bytes and the spent approval, one transaction.